Subject: Fw: clarity inquiry
Date: Tuesday, May 23, 2023 at 12:35:29 PM Argentina Standard Time
From: Augusto Gandia
To: Judi Segall
Attachments: image001.png

Dear Judi,

here sharing a compilation of emails to back up today's discussion (no need to read it).
Looking foward,

Augusto

From: Mark Burry <mburry@swin.edu.au>
Sent: Monday, May 22, 2023 2:52 PM
To: Augusto Gandia
Cc: Nicola Ferralis; Mark Goulthorpe
Subject: Re: clarity inquiry

Dear Augusto,

My apologies for not having responded earlier – last week I have been dealing with the bereavement of a close family member in the UK and participating on the SNSF Expert Panel review of the NCCR DFab at your alma mater..

I will be happy to pick-up our conversation from today looking at publication strategies… it's an extremely competitive environment as you know, and I am happy to share my insights on the subject in case they have some value. Are you free on Wednesday straight after the team meeting that we rescheduled due to next Monday being a public holiday?

Best wishes,

Mark

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From: Augusto Gandia <gandia@mit.edu>
Date: Wednesday, 17 May 2023 at 04:07
To: mark.goulthorpe@decoi.com <mark.goulthorpe@decoi.com>
Cc: Mark Burry <mburry@swin.edu.au>, George N Stiny <stiny@mit.edu>, Nicola Ferralis <ferralis@mit.edu>, Nicholas de Monchaux <ndm@mit.edu>
Subject: Re: clarity inquiry

Quick correction:

> As I stated the first day coming to mit, my aspiration was to pursue an academic career and not to join a company/startup.

From: Mark Goulthorpe <mark.goulthorpe@decoi.com>
Sent: Tuesday, May 16, 2023 4:06 PM
To: Augusto Gandia
Cc: mburry@swin.edu.au; George N Stiny; Nicola Ferralis; Nicholas de Monchaux
Subject: Re: clarity inquiry

Augusto

The work you have done on the Venice project is a miniature rather than a model, and follows on from your prior parametric modeling of elements that feed into the actual production of what we all feel is a pioneering house, both in its CAD-CAM and material aspects. As such it's a vital working-through of the architectural definition of the StealthHouse, which is the remit of the MIT team whose work is funded by ARPA-e. You've expressed preference for the CAD-CAM research where Gal and Soala have preferred to work on the energy and life cycle analysis aspects with Transsolar and Stanford.

My prior exhibitions at Venice have similarly involved large teams of people, some paid, some voluntary, all contributing to the framing of the architecture. This ARPA-e team is larger than

any before, certainly, as there are perhaps 10 external groups involved, many also involved in the last Biennale. My policy prior to and while at MIT has been to try to fairly credit everyone for the work they have done, which Mark Burry can attest to - his teams have often helped us in the past, often for nothing other than citation in the exhibition. Many architects do not do this, feeling that paying salary entitles an office to absorb employee effort without credit, but I've never understood that given the manner of the work I do - especially the composites research vitally requires a shared ethic. Just yesterday we discussed the America's Cup teams exemplifying collective creativity, with no single "architect" given the complex nature of the boats and the many different aptitudes they require.

In general architecture requires a diverse array of skills, and any project requires a division of labor: we can't all do everything. I was unaware that you would have liked to work on the virtual exhibition until now - you seemed productively and pleasurably immersed in absorbing the files of Kii Kang and Marc Downie and translating them to 3D print files, no? You had certainly seemed fulfilled.

I have never thought of an architecture exhibition, or even a project, as a "publication" that could be credited like a science paper in a refereed journal. In some cases it might be appropriate, but here there has been and continues to be a diverse and multiple authorship. 15 years of my work, supported by many other people, and the StealthHouse design and engineering even preceded your time at MIT, I think? So if you feel that you have contributed more than say, Radek Michalik, or Mark Burry, or Kii, then I would have to disagree: they've contributed conceptually and just in terms of hours to a very considerable degree. Venice is a pleasurable privilege, always hugely demanding and draining, but a significant benchmark of attainment given that it is by invitation, showcasing progressive work. Each time I have brought my office (and myself) close to bankruptcy, but looking back it was this effort that led to invitation to become a professor at MIT: it's seen as a vital contribution to the field. No one asked if I alone did all the work - they could see I orchestrated teams capable of executing promising lines of inquiry, some quite raw and un-polished. You heard my enthusiasm this weekend for the taped-together latency of your model - something rearing its head for the first time.

So bravo, as I said a few times the past few days - I would hope that the sense of attainment and recognition would suffice? These milestones we carry forwards to the next opportunity, quite formative as they are absorbed. I'm very happy with your contribution, certainly. So thank you.

Yours,

Mark Goulthorpe
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On May 16, 2023, at 17:45, Augusto Gandia <gandia@mit.edu> wrote:

Marks,

any update on the research request about publications and credits I did a week ago and didn't get a definitive answer?

I have to admit that I am not satisfied the way things were handled during this Venice thing.

I felt clearly pushed aside from any research contribution and being relegated to building a model (can share emails and they way tasks were assigned). I accepted this thinking that we would be dividing it according to our skills (or lack of skills) but expecting a fair recognition on for example, the publication (question of the two first authors that has not being answered yet). And presenting, which I clearly stated that I wanted to present, also proposed to share the presentation with Gal, but was slowly pushed away from that.

As I stated the first day coming to mit, my aspiration was to pursue an academic career and to join a company/startup.
Hopefully we can move soon towards a clear academic path.

Best,
Augusto